



UNIVERSITY OF GOTHENBURG

DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

Course Guide

Autumn Semester 2025

EU2215

Europe in the World

15 Higher Education Credits

Centre for European Studies
Department of Political Science
University of Gothenburg

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Introduction

Welcome to *Europe in the World*!

This course is offered within the Master's Programme in European Studies (two-year programme) and coordinated by the Department of Political Science. This semi-elective course examines Europe's role and place in the international system from an interdisciplinary perspective, drawing on approaches from both the Social Sciences and the Humanities.

The course investigates how Europe engages with the wider world—politically, economically, socially, and in terms of security—through both historical and contemporary perspectives. “Europe” is understood broadly, encompassing not only the European Union, but also European states, international organisations, and civil society actors. We will assess the global significance of European integration, the ways in which global developments shape Europe, and the changing role of Europe in a shifting world order.

The course is structured in two main parts. The first introduces a system-level analysis of Europe in the world, focusing on global governance, the EU as a global actor, and shifting power dynamics in international politics. The second part applies a thematic lens to three key areas—security, trade, and migration—examining their evolution across time and their impact on Europe. Themes include the broadening concept of security and European strategies in this area; the EU's role in the global political economy and trading system; and the multifaceted effects of international migration on European states and societies.

Teaching is carried out through a combination of lectures and seminars. You will engage in both oral and written assignments, culminating in a final research paper. This guide provides you with the expected learning outcomes of the course, the program of lectures and seminars, core textbook readings, a list of participating teachers, and details on assessment and written assignments. The full schedule is available on Canvas.

We look forward to exploring these important questions with you and hope you find the course both intellectually stimulating and rewarding.

Learning outcomes

Knowledge and understanding

- After completion of the course, the student shall be able to:
 - have in-depth knowledge of how Europe's role in the world has developed and how Europe's presence in the international political and economic systems can be conceived;
- have in-depth understanding of Europe's role in the world on issues relating to security, trade and migration; and
- have in-depth knowledge of the utility of different theories and methods applied to the study of security, trade and migration in a global context.

Skills and abilities

- have the ability to critically assess the utility of different theoretical and methodological approaches;
- have the ability to select and apply concepts and theories to specific empirical research problems and recognize the basic costs and benefits of those selections;
- have the ability to use written and spoken language with precision;
- have the ability to plan and present research; and
- independently produce text in accordance with good academic practice, including proper citation technique and use of references

Judgement and approach

- have a good overview of contemporary research on Europe's role in the world; and
- be able to critically analyse and think conceptually about Europe's role in the world, using reasoned arguments.

Teachers

Lisbeth Aggestam, Associate Professor, Department of Political Science,
lisbeth.aggestam@gu.se

Cecilia Malmström, Guest Professor, School of Economics, Business and Law, and former EU Commissioner.

Richard Nakamura, Senior Lecturer, Department of Business Administration, School of Business, Economics and Law, richard.nakamura@gu.se

Leonie Reicheneder, PhD Candidate, Department of Political Science,
leonie.reicheneder@gu.se

Fredrik Söderbaum, Professor, School of Global Studies,
fredrik.soderbaum@globalstudies.gu.se

Julian Walterskirchen, PhD Candidate, Department of Political Science,
julian.walterskirchen@gu.se

Martin Westlund, PhD Candidate, Department of Law, School of Business, Economics and Law, martin.westlund@law.gu.se

Schedule

This course will be taught on campus and it is important to check the schedule regularly. Changes of time or room might occur. Please look out for updates here on Canvas. Times are noted with “academic quarter” if not otherwise stated.

Course Readings

These two textbooks are mandatory reading on this course.

- Hill, Christopher, Smith, Michael, and Sophie Vanhoonacker, eds. (2023), *International Relations and the European Union*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Gstöhl, Sieglinde & Simon Schunz, eds. (2021): *The External Action of the European Union. Concepts, Approaches, Theories*. London: Red Globe Press.

You are expected to read all the required readings listed for each lecture and seminar and to pick and choose from the supplementary readings to further deepen your knowledge of the subject. The full list of readings is listed under each lecture module. To further explore the course topics, you may find additional readings by searching in the Library Catalogue, on Google Scholar, or other internet sources. You may also look at the reference lists included in the books and articles in the course literature.

Lecture Program

- 1. Course Introduction** (Lisbeth Aggestam)
- 2. Europe in a Multipolar World** (Lisbeth Aggestam)
- 3. The European Union as a Global Actor** (Lisbeth Aggestam)
- 4. EU and Other Regions in Global Governance** (Fredrik Söderbaum)
- 5. Europe in a Multipolar World of Geopolitical Tensions** (Cecilia Malmström)
- 6. Global and European Security** (Lisbeth Aggestam)
- 7. Transatlantic Relations** (Lisbeth Aggestam)
- 8. Europeanization of National Foreign and Security Policy** (Lisbeth Aggestam)
- 9. The Institutional Dimension of EU Trade Policy** (Richard Nakamura)
- 10. Exercising EU Trade Policy** (Richard Nakamura)
- 11. EU as a Global Aid Actor** (Fredrik Söderbaum)
- 12. Globalisation and Migration** (Martin Westerlund)
- 13. European Immigration Policy and Attitudes to Migration** (Martin Westerlund)
- 14. Migration and Foreign Policy** (Lisbeth Aggestam)
- 15. Writing a Research Essay** (Lisbeth Aggestam)

Seminar Program

- 1. European Strategic Autonomy** (Julian Walterskirchen)
- 2. EU trade and investment policy in a new geopolitical and geoeconomic environment**
(Richard Nakamura)
- 3. Reforming the Asylum System** (Martin Westerlund)
- 4. Research Essay Seminar** (Aggestam/Reicheneder/Walterskirchen)

Assessment

The course is worth 15 higher education credits. There are three forms of assessments on this course, which must be completed in order to receive a pass for the entire course and to fulfil the learning outcomes. These consist of:

1. Active participation in three seminars with written assignments (3 x 2 hec)
2. An oral seminar presentation (1 hec)
3. A written research essay of 3, 000 words (8 hec)

(1) *Active seminar presentation:* There are three seminars on this course and participation is mandatory. You are required to actively prepare for and participate in all three seminars, including written assignments. Each seminar is evaluated with the grade High Pass/Pass or Fail.

(2) *Oral seminar presentation:* You will be required to make **one** oral seminar presentation on this course. In preparation for the seminar, you will be working with around 4-5 students and prepare a collective group presentation based on the specific instructions for each seminar. The seminars are student-led and based on teamwork. The main responsibility for prompting an engaging seminar discussion lies with the presenters. Therefore, you need to plan the group presentation carefully and prepare questions for discussion. You are assigned a group at the start of the course. Based on an evaluation of your performance in the presentation, you will receive a Pass or Fail.

(3) *Written essay (3,000 words):* Towards the end of the course, you will be able to choose to write on a specific research topic. The research essay should focus on a research problem and issue that incorporates **at least two** of the three themes that this course has focused on, i.e. security, trade, and migration. You should demonstrate in this essay your knowledge of how and why these themes both conceptually and empirically overlap in diverse ways. Writing the research essay offers you the opportunity to explore in-depth a particular issue and research problem that you find particularly interesting. More detailed instructions can be found on Canvas Module.

Your paper is an individual piece of work that you are expected to write in your own words. AI-generated text is not allowed (see policy below). All papers will be checked for plagiarism. The

essay is assessed using the grades Fail, Pass, or Pass with Distinction.

In case of missed seminars or fail grade

- If you are absent from a theme seminar but submitted a paper, you need to complete an **extra assignment** and write a text of **1,000 words** that is a critical analysis of two additional academic articles. Please **contact the seminar teacher** to receive instructions. Submit the extra assignment in the appropriate submission folder on Canvas.
- If you are unable to make an oral presentation, you are referred to the re-take examination. Make a **recorded video** and upload on Canvas before deadline.
- If you are unable to submit a paper to a theme seminar on time, you are referred to the **re-take** examination.
- If your theme seminar paper received a fail-grade, you are to submit a new version of the same paper at the re-take examination, addressing comments from the teacher.
- If you are unable to submit the research essay, you are referred to the re-take examination.
- If your research seminar essay received a fail-grade, you are to submit a new version of the same paper, addressing the comments raised by the teacher.
- Check the dates for re-take examinations listed under Assignments. The re-takes are graded by the respective seminar teacher.

Grading scale

To obtain the Pass grade the student must fulfil all the learning outcomes. To obtain Pass with Distinction, the work of the student should show a very good ability to connect theoretical analyses to practical outcomes, a good, independent analytical ability and that written assignments fulfil high academic standards in terms of structure and language.

A student must receive a Pass for all four assignments, including the oral presentation, to pass the entire course. All seminar papers (including active participation and performance at the seminars) are evaluated with the grades “pass with distinction”, “pass” or “fail”. For the grade “pass with distinction” on the course as a whole, a student is required to receive a high pass (VG) for the

main research essay (8 HEC) as well as at least one of the theme seminar papers, and pass on the rest. Oral presentation (1 HEC) is evaluated with the grade pass or fail.

Academic Writing

The three hallmarks of good academic writing are clarity, precision, and intellectual honesty. Unlike some other forms of writing, academic texts should be free from ambiguity, and they should offer the reader plainly stated arguments, not rhetorical tricks. This does not mean that they have to be boring, of course, but it does mean that, whenever there is a conflict between being linguistically elegant and clear, the latter should take precedence. For example, in academic writing, it might be preferable to consistently use the same terms for the same concepts instead of using synonyms, even though this would be dull in other types of writing (such as fiction). To organize the text, a good rule of thumb is to make one point per paragraph.

Good academic writing is cumulative; it proceeds from, communicates with, and seeks to contribute to previous work on the topic of choice. It is essential that the author (or authors) gives due credit to previous work. There should never be any doubt as to whether segments of text, ideas, claims or results are the author's own or drawn from other sources. To ensure this, academic writing requires a transparent system of citation. Never 'copy and paste' text from other sources without citing those sources and enclosing direct quotes in quotation marks. Copying text without indicating it is a quotation constitutes plagiarism. Use references consistently and accurately. These requirements hold for all academic texts, from short student assignments and course papers to master theses and academic books and journal articles.

Here are two links that further describe the essentials of academic writing (please click "In English" in case the page appears in Swedish):

Searching and citing: <http://www.ub.gu.se/skriva/>

Tutorial in basic information seeking and information management:

<http://www.ub.gu.se/webbkurs/>

Language Support:

<http://studentportal.gu.se/english/help-and-guidance/language-support/faculty-of-social-sciences/?languageId=100001>

Information regarding how to write name etc. on take home exams/papers

Please add this information in the header on the first page of your papers/essays.

Last name:

First name:

Personal Number:

Course:

Part of Course:

Grading Teacher

Policies

Screen Use Policy: Screens and computers are permitted in class strictly for note-taking purposes. Research and experience show that the effectiveness of educational activities relies on collective attention. When someone uses a screen for unrelated activities, it distracts others and diminishes the overall learning experience.

AI policy: The use of generative AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT) for writing assignments is limited to brainstorming and outlining purposes only. Direct copying of AI-generated text is strictly prohibited, and AI must not be used for drafting or writing any part of the assignment. These assignments are designed to foster your critical thinking, analytical skills, and the ability to express original analysis and ideas. The purpose of this policy is to ensure the work remains your own and that you continuously practice your own skills in academic writing.

Plagiarism: Academic writing is based on the principle of clarity and transparency regarding the source of the information and knowledge conveyed in the text. In academic writing, we use others' ideas, thoughts, arguments, opinions, and conclusions, but we make the origin of these clear by citing and referencing. We rely on, communicate with, build upon, and credit previous research, authors, and sources—but we do NOT copy them! Copying is plagiarism, i.e., cheating. You can read more on academic writing and plagiarism on the Canvas course page. The Department of Political Science uses sophisticated plagiarism detection systems. Teachers are also skilled at detecting texts that are not independently written through critical reading. We are obliged to report suspected cheating to the Disciplinary Board at GU. Cheating can result in a warning or suspension from the program. Read more on plagiarism at GU's student portal.

Equal Treatment: The University of Gothenburg aims to promote equal rights and opportunities for students and employees and to combat discrimination related to gender, gender identity or gender expressions, ethnicity, religion or other beliefs, sexual

orientation, disability or age. If, however, you as a student at the Department of Political Science become subject to such acts and actions, we encourage you to contact us to enable the opportunity for appropriate action. You can contact: the course coordinator, Director of studies Birgitta Niklasson, Equal treatment representative Ulrika Möller, or Student counselor Eva Nilsson. Student counselors have confidentiality. You can also turn to these persons if you experience problems or discomfort in the study environment, even if not targeted at you. Contact information is available on our website.